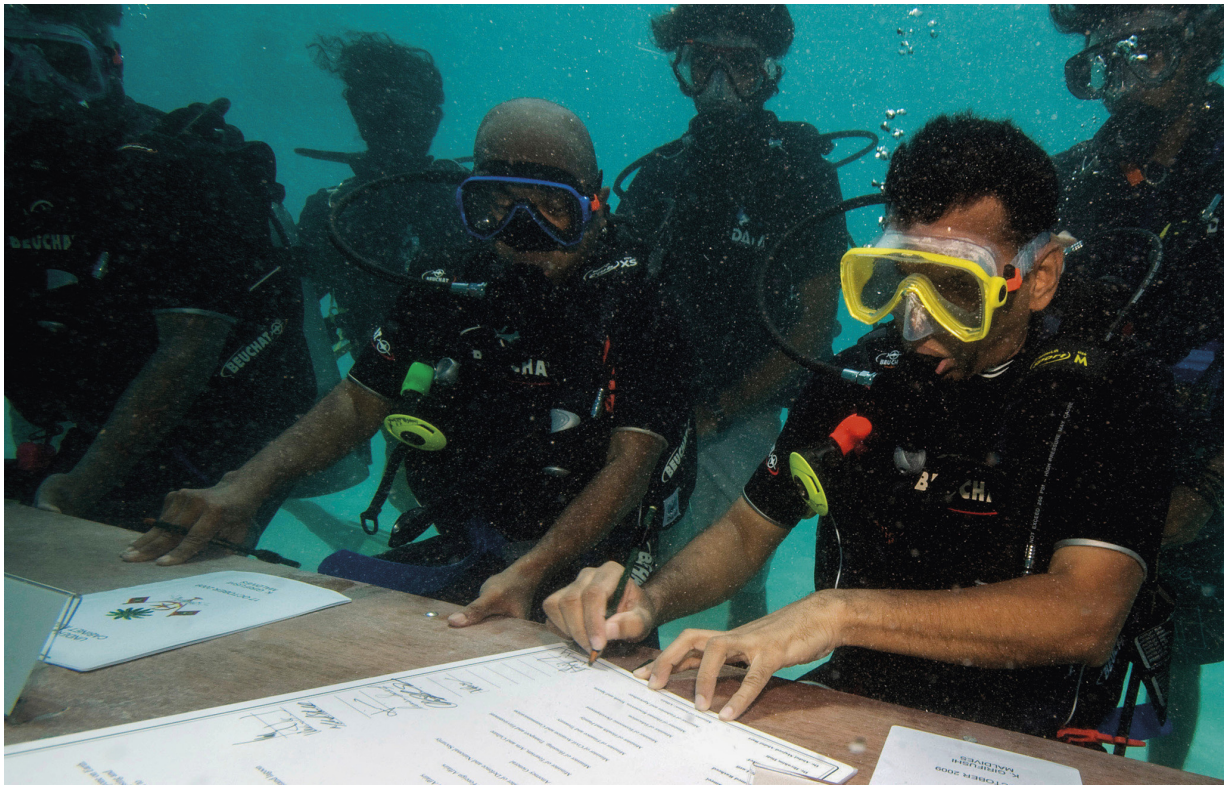
In December 2012, parties met to agree on a new set of emission-reducing targets for 2012–20, the second commitment period. However, in 2015 the Paris Agreement was signed, this time calling on all nations—not just developed countries—to reduce their emissions. This new agreement effectively replaced the Kyoto Protocol.



An underwater cabinet meeting is held in the Maldives in 2009 to call for action against climate change. Rising sea levels could mean that the nation is eventually swallowed by the ocean.

Paris and the future

In November 2016, after decades of calls for a more aggressive global resolution of climate change, the Paris Agreement was signed by 195 UNFCCC member countries at the UN headquarters in New York City. Like Kyoto, the primary aim of the Paris Agreement is to cut greenhouse gas emissions to agreed-upon levels.